Twice in a while

renj

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Foreword

There is a precise geometry to the way I have dismantled myself. For years, I believed that to be a complete individual was to be the sum of one's experiences, polished and presented in the correct order. I treated my life like a rigorous proof, ensuring every variable was accounted for and every outcome was predicted with statistical coldness. But this collection is not a proof; it is the record of an error. It is the documentation of a variable I could not account for, a force that acted upon my core with such violence that I found myself arriving at a result that defies standard addition.

To be caught in this orbit is to be an experimental failure. It is to find that the "me" I spent nineteen years constructing—the learner, the poet, the analyst—is suddenly insufficient when placed alongside the reality of someone else. In these ten entries, I have tried to map that subtraction. You will find that the language here is often jagged, shifting between the clinical certainty of a mind trying to maintain order and the chaotic, nectar-oozing reality of a spirit that has stopped caring about the integrity of its own borders. I am not documenting the joy of being whole; I am documenting the strange, intoxicating relief of being incomplete.

"For I am lesser than the sum of my parts." This is not a lament; it is an axiomatic truth discovered in the wake of a collision. I have discarded the "rehearsed" versions of myself, not because they were false, but because they were too heavy to carry into the dawn. What remains is a particle—small, erratic, and impossible to disprove. I invite you to read these entries not as a narrative of rescue, but as the raw data of a surrender. There is no savior here, only the sharp, dizzying math of being exactly, dangerously, and definitively less than I used to be.

This Is Enough

renj

Breathe in, the dominoes will hopefully do their jobs tonight.
The scratches inside the walls are signs that it will be right.
The shoes are not too empty, the tights are not too loose,
And probably for the very first time, it's a choice I get to choose.

I have spent a fortune in casinos on melancholia;
For some time, my edges have rusted off painful nostalgia.
But this one feels different, as if the Jack did all his trades right,
And the dark clubs and spades spun themselves to the light.

This faith might be blinding, but it could be eye-opening.
Take my sight, and take my guts away. Throw me into the inning.
Tearduct lines turn into footnotes of the thickest history books;
A lifetime awaiting a conclusion, a single touch would ruin the crooks.
This time, it is enough to get me out of bed.

Cycle in, the psychedelics will repulse themselves later;
Take in the chair opposite the table and make the food taste better.
The seat is not too tight, a chin enough to grin, a tale enough to tell,
A sight to behold, flowers to uphold with a story I cannot foretell.

I have spent a mouthful on screaming and crying for a lightning strike;
Such strong faith returned rather weak rumbles of spike.
The flesh brushes off bones, bones rearranging, the nerves on edge,
All for a story that feels too gold to be let into the dying age.

This faith might be deafening, but it could be music to waltz to;
Take my sight and see if we share the same musings too.
The billowing heavens on my cheeks paint a scarlet future,
Too striking, enough to unravel a red carpet and a true couture.
This time, it is enough to let it get into my head.

Faux hearts and faux runners have chased the sun for light,
Only for their legs to freeze still and remain forever uptight.
To be one in the marathon is a lived asylum one would stay in,
For the rush of the crash is a beast that strikes ever when.
A gentle sinkhole could send the entire plane onto itself;
These legs swaddle like a lost invertebrate in an ocean shelf,
Trying to find any sort of incandescence to guide its senses;
A faux mind and true spirit is probably enough to last the tenses.
Past, future, present, a light not measured in kilometers but by strides,
And to have found it blindly is one up for these treacherous tides.
This faith may have been born blind, deaf, and debilitating.

Take me in, for despite the currents and tides, I am breathing.
The ashes from the mountains, the heat of the pearl would transcend,
And the flushes on my fingertips can hold whatever sort of append.
For this time is not enough.
For this is enough to last time itself.
For the first time, it's more than enough.

Underneath my tongue are the words I can't bring to say,
And behind my eyes is a history that has turned to gray.
Braids that lead to treacherous paths come to a fray;
Terrible dangers are a friend to this man of pitiful play.
Production value outwits the musicality of rationality;
The overnight rush takes out any remaining ounce of logicality.
Throw it out and see if what we have is of originality,
But I believe so, because they are arcs of utter practicality.

The voice comes through the wire as if it is lightning-fast;
Distance that I seek is distance that I avoided in the past.
The closer kind inhabits my body and turns hesitance to rust,
For I am pretty sure that this gaze would, for a long time, last.
The violence of dancers inside my ribcage is uncontainable;
An encore happens at the most stupid time it can ripple.
The edges of my bed have turned themselves into a squircle,
As if the blame is on the dragons that ooze my size of particle.

I lay my bag on the kitchen counter and look for ginger;
These butterflies have to be tamed before I dismember.
On a bathroom line, I see the bright, neon trigger,
Standing side on another door like it's true weather.
If the night stays through the day, I might actually disintegrate;
Is this for a man to drop, futile, and enter his berate?
Intuitively, concealment pairs best for a debilitating state,
But oh my Lord, the nectar oozes out with my eyes as the gate.

Ginormous and a famous commitment that no one has ever hid;
For their mind blocks them out, but their guts crack open the lid.
Ulterior motives manifest in the obvious, musingly awkward bid;
A Penrose losing direction, a foot losing tour, a flower closing seed.
It opens itself, a gaze the air, the salty and the hazy kind, can't move;
Every stare feels like a pair of eyes reserved for the Louvre.
Borderline psychopathic? I don't think so, because I can't fathom;
It's an axiomatic definition of something sharp I can't disprove.

The Way Tomorrow

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Too many have come before us, all the shades they distrust.
We have also been in dark days that we both refuse to recognize.
How bad does it feel to know it takes one to know one?
I would not answer, for I have nothing to open my lips' crust,
But take my word that it is starting this night; free will be the price.
The dust from our eyes, with the breeze of tomorrow, shall be gone.

Savior shall not be a word we employ in this cabin.
Not one soul saves two from the wrath of an open ending;
Let it be insane, let it rush, let it consume inside you too.
Just hope the Sun leads us the way tomorrow.

Too many have failed for taking parts in rehearsed positions,
Roles broken by the same bent rules that glued them together,
Only to break apart for taking their vines off for themselves.
Take a promise that this Earth won't witness such actions,
From two who have pained themselves by previous throw to ether.
We'll wake up tomorrow beside each other where no one is a slave.

Savior shall not be a role one has to nail themselves in.
Not one cry eclipse the harmony of a duology of laughs;
Let it be insane, and throw the wolves off our tracks.
Just hope the Sun leads us the way tomorrow.

For every new day is the same but not a routine.
Forefathers have failed for closing their palaces from within.
Take the beauty of the islands and map them out the sea,
And you will find that in irregular boundaries, there is pristine.
Let the rush take us off our feet and be thrown with the wind;
The ships shall sail, lifting the mast, and our hands are tied free.

Savior shall not be a destination circled on a map.
Not one sail shall eclipse the wind that takes us free;
Let it be insane, and throw the sand in our hands off to the aether.
Just hope the Sun leads us the way tomorrow.

The King on the Hill

On a hill was a castle a King had made for the deceased,
A lineage of truth-tellers, jesters, and past lovers.
All he did at the time was clean the premises by head,
For he made a promise to be on the grave forever.

Inside the tower are bones crushed into fine powder,
Waiting for a time the wind will blow them to aether.
The best stones were used for this magnificence,
The sturdiest woods were cut to build this convergence.

On the gold plate and the cushion of his throne,
The King still fills the sharp knives on his crown;
The peas laden in his bed, the nightshade in his head,
Even through Suns, the Moon has always bled.

A runaway from a Kingdom far comes to his palace,
Kneeling in confinement of her own indecisions,
Looking at a stern man with nails that hit like nails,
And eyes that cover the obvious and view the hideous.

"For what can these dirt-laden feet offer to you?"
The lady asks as he holds his satchel like a weight of two.
The King dismisses the damsel as air howling the wind,
And for tomorrow, he'll find the path's proper twin.

On the gold plate and the cushion of his throne,
His gaze is on the proximity of something he's withdrawn.
As if the walls of his castle have shown bleaks and creaks,
And his fortress is nothing but a creation that breaks.

The King was shocked to discover the Lady the next day,
Throwing flames on his castle of constant pertinence.
But now, he sees all the ashes burn and flare again,
The blackest of smokes flying like divine impermanence.

He has struggled to rhyme his thoughts up;
The castle has crumbled, the strongest of boulders
Was no match for this woman of beautiful mishap;
Perhaps he could lose all his riches for a pair of shoulders.

And so his crown was thrown into the aether,
As his throne turned into a legend no one will remember.
For the Lady and the King will build their own cabin,
On the woods and take splice on the waters leaving.

One Foot in

I hate how the air kisses the plastic on my back,
While on a bus dragging my feet towards the big city.
Boredom is not a seldom in these old streets
Full of new discards and efficiency of slack.
Everyone is spiritually artificial in sanctity,
That it lines in the absurdity of the ungodly breath.

One would leave this city and aloof himself up;
Every smooth flow of the air carries a nervous doubt.
Give me another pair of eyes and throw in an ear,
For I am leaving this city soon, I fear.

Dehumidifiers line up in a mall, with haze coring the halls.
I hold my breath as a figure emerges in the view,
As if an angel lifted her hands and cut through the noise.
For some days it would be best to take the stalls,
Talk for hours, being lost in this city of renewed,
To tread on the why of becoming, and the how of choice.

One foot in and I was this close to leaving out,
Only for a sunray to drop on me for a heavy doubt.
A trivialized loss turned into a beautiful mosaic,
For I reckon I am not leaving this city for this sake.

The rust on the electricity poles are covered with glue,
Full of the missing, the found, and the to-be.
One day, these posts will witness of hands on them,
Arms out, and dancing through the beat of the smoggy view,
As if in a mountain full of gears and all duty-free,
As if threads are on bank, ready for any accident of the hem.

Two pairs out into the cold and dry nights of this city,
Four feet that on rhythm with the pattern of blocks in the lining.
Everything is a stoplight for being in this busy world,
But I reckon I am not leaving this city if I could.

A Fever

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The warm air touches my face in the annoying way,
The heat and the cold mix in with the humidity.
Degrees of separation built to last a millisecond,
As if the taste of exhilaration is on the horizon.
Red marks all over my mask seep into the bones,
Pink carriages make their way into my eye cones.
Prescriptive views over descriptive ways,
A happenstance that is older than milliseconds,
Too strong, in fact, that they form my bones.

My forefathers have taught their young to know,
I may have been the end of the lineage on go.
For this is such a fever dream that I am on edge,
A point where my breath won't last me another age.
Starlight and all its star-cross fail to account for dust,
And my lungs are filled with the prettiest kind.
But they say when you know, then you know.
Perhaps this fervor is not just a fleeting edge;
Perhaps this other pair of eyes is from stardust.

The parkway was a field of unstickered vehicles,
Tires that mark the faraway origins of trickles.
Four hands that touch the wheels of fate,
Trying so hard for the time strand to stagnate.
Take this living dream, and turn it into normal,
And I come home, blaming myself for being too formal.
The sky reeks of an astrally projected vehicle,
As if a realization is to crash onto my lucid fate—
Boy, oh boy, let this fever never return to normal.

Perhaps a hijacker has taken control of my mind,
A night is on a dream that doesn't reward the kind.
Rough times are to stay with the roughest diamonds,
Carat up, and they would be on her fingertips on.
I will run to your blood-side when your heart is bleeding,
And I will keep my mask on to keep you breathing.
Chains fully broken by will of this puny mind,
Lost in eyes that are sparkling like diamonds,
And a fever that on my cheeks comes bleeding.

On the Floorboards

renj

My days were up to euthanize on the pound,
Now they rest and close their eyes on your lap.
The bridge of my nose has always sniffed out,
And traded tranquility with an error of loud.
The afterparties were as stupid as they sound;
My hands were up with the darlings of the crowd.
My hands were always on the edge of being fists,
Up until one held the circumference of my wrists.

Oh, take me back to the moment when I chased fire.
Phantoms fade into gray, deserted by their leader.
A peace of the right kind, a home at the end of the path;
Take me back in, hold the bed, and dream for some math.

My country was hellbound when it got to my hands,
My cabinet was nothing but a bunch of rubber bands,
Stretched themselves thin; my patience, thinner,
Up until your flexible lips touched my counter.
My recommendations were all on power and fame,
But now a smoothened rock lays flat on your tame.
My head was always in the hands of those who feed me,
Up until I reached out mine and held my chains free.

And it's a moment by the fireplace that made me understand,
For I have been changed by a once-thought-to-be-grand,
Now just sitting at the very tips of my hand,
And she burns brighter than the flame at the stand.

For a myth has realized itself into reality,
And the morning news is enough for memory.
One day, fate will knock on these floorboards
And check if our change has followed accords.
One, a rock obsessed with strength and fame;
One, a dog circling his home and marking his tame.
And I would let them sit on my lap as you caress their hair,
And you'll see this maze brought something fair.
My dreams were just thoughts of a bygone era;
Now they show a portrait when we're on a mirror.

And I'll call you a name only we know tonight,
Making sure my voice will eclipse the evening bright.
My hands tie my tongue, holding an inquirous fight,
Yet you said you feel right being with me tonight.

Melodramatic in Nature

renj

A theater stage is always up for someone like me,
Standing tall, preaching to a crowd to see.
A head rush, admittedly too much to handle,
And so is my stardom to the vultures of this culture.
Quite melodramatic for a man my age,
Quite reserved for a kid my age,
And the pianomen struggle to find rhythm in my steps,
My stilettos dropping off chairs from the flips.

Will you dance with a man this melodramatic in nature?

A "for hire" poster is up for dissection of human nature;
I am someone who keeps you on with a cat to mature.
One who rushes to the refrigerator door when it's hot,
And one that jumps a cliff and trades what he got.
One who has never heard the word "discrete" in his life,
And one that sees a fancy bed as murderous as a knife.
For I have a press conference for all my unimportant musings,
Yet [I am] mostly silent on days I need to realize essential somethings.

Will you listen to a man this melodramatic in nature?

But I guess the effect of knowing me is up to you;
Just know that my hands are of dirt, my playing in the garden.
I am painted with colors that I will struggle to explain;
Some of these are from the carousel horses in the bin.
A settlement with me might not sound like its root word,
But I promise that I will be a flame but never a fire consuming wood.
And in times of dark, even shadows know when to withdraw,
And even in times of the cold, ice knows when it has to thaw.

Will you stand next to a man this melodramatic in nature?
I hope you do.

The Stage Tonight

She takes the stage tonight; even the stars are in it.
The audience, stricken by the hums of the drums kicking in.
Her silhouette crowning the silver mist on the stage,
A dazzle of grace, a lot of grit takes center stage of rage.

Does she see a general admission fan in this field?
The best lights scatter her figure among her yield,
But the best gaze comes from my own mental guild,
One that is overpowered by blood both shed and grilled.

She has the microphone on the entire show,
Acts that plateau and rise, the fast, the slow,
A staircase that becomes the one that follows her,
And a strange tang in the air on the confetti she blows.

For her, it's just another day of doing her job,
But for me, it's a night I will never have.
I look at the platform descending as my wristband stops,
The glow fading and my general presence crops.

Heaven-struck by an avalanche so divine,
That it instead takes the breath of my hairline.
Beneath these soles and above these shoes lie
A sensation I could not put an item on the nameline.

And I tremble the way home, spinning around as she would,
All hopes, dreams, prayers, and knocking on wood,
As if lightning has already hit the lightning rod,
Feeling finally fulfilled by a fate betrothed.

My arms spin like a hurricane on a sunny day,
As I ideate on the silhouette that sang the theme of my play,
A crowd that's up for the musical relay,
And the gaze of a man that is here to stay.

And so I arrive home to an open porch light,
And I see her, post-show, with two plates for the dinner tonight.
The best song is played with her giggles and my flight,
Every time I see the brightest star inside my logistic freight.

Into It Everywhere

renj

Books neat on the shelf, pens scattered on the floor,
A fixation on the chaos of ink bleeds and dustboards.
A room in the dark, devoid of any shadows, is fulfilling;
In the light, the absence of strain is of the being.

Perhaps it's the buzz in the complete silence,
Or the streaks on the road on the way home.
It's in the lampposts that refuse to burn down;
Perhaps I am into it everywhere I go.

Every song on the radio is up for my tribute,
As if for a river, it is the best of its attributes.
The church bells seem to be calling my other halves,
And an addendum and corrigendum on my graphs.

Perhaps it's in the buzz in the complete silence,
Or the way the cars park in the basement.
The parallel lines that power a whole city;
Perhaps I am into it everywhere I go.

Every painting seems to be a depiction of my musings,
The gory, the dead, the lively, the still, the creating.
"Less is to more" and so "blank is to completeness,"
For the steps of the overpass paint their own finesse.

Perhaps it's in the buzz in the complete silence,
Or the leaves that brush my hair when I stand up,
The perpendicular intersections that rule the city;
Perhaps I'm into it everywhere I go.

Perhaps I'm into it everywhere I go.

For I am lesser than the sum of my parts.

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